

VEGETABLE OILS



Vegetable oils are made from the seeds and fruits of many plants growing all over the world, from tiny sesame seeds to big, juicy coconuts. The oils are used for cooking, as salad dressings, and to make cooking fats and margarine. Soybeans are the most important source of oil worldwide, especially in the US. In western Europe, the oil most widely produced is rapeseed oil.



Harvesting

Olives are picked in the fall when they are ripe. They are shaken from the trees and gathered up, usually by hand. Next, the olives are sorted out to remove the leaves and twigs, and taken to be pressed.



How olive oil is made

The olives are ground to a thick paste which is spread onto special mats. The mats are then layered up on the pressing machine which will gently squeeze them to produce olive oil.

Olive trees are often quite small but can live for hundreds of years. They develop very wrinkled, knotty trunks.

Olive trees are planted in rows. Fields of olive trees are called groves.

